

STAGE FIVE • THINKING, REASONING & MENTAL MODELS

FIRSTS

ADAPTATION NOTES

Online vs. in-person format notes for every activity that changes shape

A Citrus Edition Facilitator Resource • Companion to the FIRSTS Manual

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FIRSTS • Adaptation Notes

Stage Five • Thinking, Reasoning & Mental Models

PURPOSE

Stage Five's group activities are almost entirely conversational and reflective, no devices or physical materials required beyond something to write with, which makes this one of the more straightforward stages to adapt between formats.

This document covers every activity across Stage Five's Group Versions of Key Exercises document that genuinely changes shape between formats. Most adaptations here are minor; the one meaningful exception is collaborative map-building, which benefits from a genuinely shared visual surface in either format.

Format Notes by Activity

Activity	In-Person	Online
Peer Weight-Check (FIRST G4)	Pairs physically swap printed or written matrices.	Breakout rooms of 2. Have Partner A share their screen (or a photo of their matrix) showing only weights and criteria, hiding the actual decision context until after the guess.
Steelman Swap (FIRST G6)	Pairs turn to face each other, verbally swap claims.	Breakout rooms of 2. Have each person type their claim in the breakout room chat first, so the partner can reread it carefully rather than relying on a single verbal pass.
Outside Mirror (FIRST G9)	Groups of 3 sit in a small circle for a genuine, quiet conversation.	Breakout rooms of 3. This works well online since it's a seated, conversational activity with no physical materials needed.
Collaborative Map-Building (FIRST G10)	Small groups gather around a whiteboard or large shared paper.	Use a shared virtual whiteboard (Miro, Jamboard, or a shared slide) that all group members can edit simultaneously in a breakout room.
Blind Spot Panel (FIRST H16)	Groups of 3 in a small circle.	Breakout rooms of 3. Works naturally online; no materials needed beyond conversation.
Failure Auction (FIRST H18)	Small groups write ideas on sticky notes and physically rank them on a wall or table.	Use a shared doc or virtual whiteboard where each person adds their failure-mode ideas, then the group reorders them by dragging or renumbering.
Full-group share-outs / closing rounds	Genuine round-robin around the room.	Use "raise hand" or call names directly from a list rather than open-floor, which tends to stall on video.

GENERAL HYBRID GUIDANCE

For collaborative map-building (FIRST G10) in a hybrid session, use one shared virtual whiteboard for the entire group, in-person and remote participants alike, rather than a physical whiteboard for the room and a separate virtual one for remote participants. A single shared surface keeps both groups genuinely building the same map instead of two disconnected ones.